

Codex subscription capacity: executive report

Evidence through 6 September 2026, 20:20 UTC. Eight anonymous account histories.

Recovered workload has substantial reference value at standard API rates. Later dollar value per reported quota point falls partly because API prices changed and partly alongside Astra/high usage. A recent bank-reset penalty remains unresolved.

For a EUR200 comparison, July's recovered account values range from **15.0x to 26.0x**, August from **10.1x to 85.6x**, and September 1–6 from **3.4x to 28.9x**. These ratios divide dated standard API-equivalent workload value by EUR200. Actual invoices, complete billing periods and some historical account assignments remain unverified. The ratios measure recovered reference value. Measuring a return on paid subscription spend requires those missing records. September covers only the observed part of the month.

What changed in the comparable workload

A quota point means one percentage point of the provider's reported weekly usage. Higher dollars per point mean more API-equivalent workload for the same displayed quota movement.

Dominant workload and observation period	Hours / accounts	Quota points	Dated USD per point	At 6 September prices
Sol/max, before 21 August	42 / 6	281	\$22.52	\$17.59
Sol/max, 21–31 August	102 / 6	803	\$19.14	\$19.14
Sol/max, 1–6 September	35 / 7	277	\$17.65	\$17.65
Astra/high, 5–6 September	11 / 3	226	\$9.34	\$9.34

The August API price cut explains a substantial part of the apparent fall in dollar value. At constant prices, the earlier Sol cohort is close to September's Sol cohort. The later Astra cohort yields about half September Sol's API-equivalent dollars per reported point. Model, effort, date, workload and reset origin overlap, so the observed difference cannot be assigned to a model or provider-policy change alone. No pure xhigh cohort passes the comparison controls.

The main comparison uses intervals with at least five points of movement, stable quota deadlines and fresh observations. At least 95% of reference value must come from one model/effort combination and pass the stricter source checks. All recovered concurrent work on the account contributes to the numerator. Missing work and unrecorded Fast usage can still affect the result.

What banking shows

Three directly recorded August banked Sol/max windows yield **\$2,452.59, \$2,527.81 and \$2,473.92** of dated API-equivalent workload over 99 points each. At common prices they average **\$19.63 per point**, close to **\$19.59** in the remaining ordinary-compatible window that starts before 21 August. That control spans 20–22 August. Later ordinary-compatible windows on two of the same accounts also have similar common-price value.

Two windows once classified from quota timestamps as ordinary have ambiguous origins after manual resets and idle deadline changes. They are excluded from the ordinary comparison. The earlier bank evidence shows no halving in those August windows. A September-specific reduction still requires contemporaneous ordinary and banked windows with comparable workloads.

Three later Astra/high probable-bank windows yield **\$764.51, \$952.38 and \$1,023.17** over 99 points each. The accounts, workloads and reset evidence differ, so this spread alone cannot establish unequal subscription entitlements.

What the evidence can support

Replay correction removes **37.1% of candidate calls** and **41.5% of their standard reference dollars**. Raw cumulative totals would materially overstate usage. The subset with stricter source checks retains 1.69 million account-attributed calls. Lease records provide only partial independent corroboration.

The Reddit comparison reports fewer tokens after a reset, but also changes reasoning levels, model mix, cache share, compactions and retries. Its aggregate table does not isolate a bank-specific capacity factor. The combined claim of ordinary value falling from roughly \$2,500 to \$650 remains unestablished.

The most useful next observations are passive, per-request account and service-tier records, timestamped quota and bank-action responses, and subscription-linked invoices. Repeated ordinary and banked windows on the same account, model and effort would distinguish a reset penalty from changed workload or general metering. The provider's hidden-credit mechanism remains unobserved.

The [dossier](#) contains account tables, figures, source qualifications and reproduction commands.